BUSINESS PLAN FOR CASSIOPEIA GIRLS TECH

Designed by cassiopeia girls tech team

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Executive Summary

Cassiopeia Girls Tech is an Ethiopian organization dedicated to empowering young girls who are passionate about coding and technology. Our mission is to bridge the gender gap in technology fields by providing girls with access to skills based training, resources and mentorship that will prepare them for successful careers in the tech industry. We aim to inspire and equip a generation of young women to not only enter these fields but also thrive and lead in them. Cassiopeia Girls Tech seeks to be a supportive and empowering platform that helps girls build both technical expertise and the confidence to pursue their dreams in tech.

Currently, only a small percentage of Ethiopian girls choose technology related fields with most young women pursuing careers in social sciences or health. Although recent efforts within Ethiopia's educational system have aimed to encourage more women to enter science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) fields. Technology remains significantly underrepresented. Among the women who do join engineering programs. A high percentage choose software engineering, computer science, or IT-related courses. However, despite high enrollment many graduates lack the practical hands on skills needed to succeed professionally as their education is largely curriculum based with limited access to real-world experience.

Cassiopeia Girls Tech's work aligns with Ethiopia's ambitious "5 Million Coders" initiative a nationwide effort to provide tech training for youth supported by government sponsorship. While this initiative is a promising step toward building a digitally skilled population, it must include targeted support for young women, who face unique social and educational challenges that often hinder their progress in tech. By creating tailored training programs and mentorship specifically for girls, Cassiopeia Girls Tech supports Ethiopia's vision of becoming a hub for tech talent, ensuring that girls have an equal stake in this transformation.

Our goal is to build a network of skilled and confident young women in Ethiopia who are prepared to contribute meaningfully to the tech workforce. Cassiopeia Girls Tech provides coding workshops, project-based learning, mentorship from industry professionals, and community events that foster collaboration. Through these efforts, we aim to address the gaps in the traditional curriculum and nurture a generation of skilled, innovative, and resilient women who will lead Ethiopia's tech industry forward.

Introduction / Background

Cassiopeia Girls Tech was established to address the significant gap in technology and coding opportunities for girls in Ethiopia. Despite a growing interest among young women in

technology fields such as Software Engineering, Computer Science, and IT, the majority face barriers to acquiring practical skills essential for success in today's competitive tech landscape. Many female students enrolled in these programs find that their education focuses heavily on theory, leaving them underprepared for hands-on, industry-relevant work. Cassiopeia Girls Tech seeks to bridge this gap by offering targeted, practical coding and technology training specifically designed for girls who aspire to build careers in tech.

One of the primary challenges faced by young women in Ethiopia is the lack of accessible, affordable training programs. Although a few government and private initiatives support general coding education, these programs are either costly or limited in scope, making them difficult for most girls to access. Moreover, existing models tend to focus on short-term or foundational knowledge rather than the in-depth, full-stack skills needed to excel in the tech industry. Cassiopeia Girls Tech is filling this void by developing a free, online full-stack development training program tailored for girls, where participants will progress through five comprehensive phases, covering all essential aspects of full-stack development.

Our program stands out not only because it is free and accessible but also because it is led by a dedicated team of volunteer teachers and mentors who bring real-world industry experience to the classroom. By conducting registration and classes entirely online, we aim to eliminate geographical and financial barriers, ensuring that girls from all backgrounds and regions can participate. This initiative will empower girls with the technical skills needed to navigate Ethiopia's evolving digital economy and support Ethiopia's broader "5 Million Coders" initiative, which seeks to produce a digitally skilled workforce.

In creating this program, we drew inspiration from successful tech education models worldwide, tailoring our curriculum to meet the unique needs of Ethiopian girls. By focusing on full-stack development and offering project-based learning, mentorship, and peer collaboration, Cassiopeia Girls Tech aims to equip girls with both technical proficiency and the confidence to lead in Ethiopia's growing tech industry. Through this approach, we are committed to building a supportive community where girls can learn, grow, and realize their potential in technology.

Mission and Vision

Mission

Cassiopeia Girls Tech is committed to empowering Ethiopian girls by providing them with accessible, high-quality coding and technology education. Our mission is to bridge the gender gap in technology by fostering practical skills, confidence, and a supportive community that encourages girls to pursue and excel in technology fields. We aim to create pathways for girls to

build successful careers in tech, making them contributors to and leaders in Ethiopia's digital future.

Vision

Our vision is an Ethiopia where young women are equally represented in the tech industry, equipped with the skills, resources, and support needed to drive innovation and change. We envision a society where every girl interested in coding and technology has the opportunity to develop her potential, regardless of socio-economic or geographical barriers. In the long term, Cassiopeia Girls Tech aspires to build a network of skilled, confident women who will lead Ethiopia's tech industry, serving as role models and mentors for future generations.

Long-term Impact

Through Cassiopeia Girls Tech, we aim to transform the lives of Ethiopian girls by providing not only technical training but also a strong foundation in problem-solving, critical thinking, and collaborative skills. By fostering these abilities, we empower girls to break the stereotypes associated with women in tech, driving long-term change in Ethiopia's workforce. We seek to create a ripple effect—where girls who thrive in our program go on to inspire and uplift others, building a more inclusive, innovative, and gender-balanced tech landscape in Ethiopia.

Goals and Objectives

Goals

1. Empowerment Through Education

Provide high-quality, practical coding and technology education to at least 500 girls across Ethiopia within the next three years.

2. Community Building and Networking

Establish a supportive community of girls interested in technology, with 50% of participants engaging in mentorship or networking activities by the end of the first year.

3. Skill Development and Employability

Equip at least 80% of our program graduates with job-ready skills in full-stack development, positioning them for internships, jobs, or entrepreneurial opportunities within Ethiopia's tech industry.

4. Impact and Outreach

Conduct awareness campaigns to reach a wider audience, with a goal of engaging 1,000 girls and their families through workshops, webinars, and outreach events by the end of the second year.

Short-term Objectives (1 Year)

- Launch the full-stack development program with an initial cohort of 100 girls from various regions in Ethiopia, focusing on online accessibility.
- Conduct monthly workshops on foundational coding skills, attended by at least 75% of registered participants.
- Establish a network of 20 volunteer teachers and mentors who are actively involved in mentoring students and offering career guidance.
- Organize three community-building events, such as hackathons or webinars, to foster collaboration and enhance students' exposure to real-world tech challenges.

Long-term Objectives (3-5 Years)

- Expand the full-stack development program to cover additional specialized tech areas, such as data science, mobile development, and cybersecurity, to diversify career paths for graduates.
- Grow our community to reach 1,500 girls across Ethiopia, creating regional chapters to facilitate in-person mentorship and skill-sharing among participants.
- Develop partnerships with local tech companies, NGOs, and government bodies to secure internship and job placements for at least 60% of program graduates.
- Implement a robust tracking system to measure program impact, aiming to have 90% of graduates demonstrate increased confidence, tech skills, and career readiness through post-program assessments and surveys.

Business Description & Market Opportunity

Ethiopia's technology sector is expanding rapidly, yet women remain underrepresented due to societal, financial, and educational barriers. While government initiatives such as the "5 Million Coders" program exist, they lack a dedicated focus on empowering women. Cassiopeia Girls Tech fills this gap by providing targeted, practical training for young women, ensuring they have the technical and professional skills needed to succeed in the workforce. The growing digital transformation in Ethiopia and Africa presents a unique opportunity to equip young women with digital skills that meet industry demands.

Products & Services

- **Full-Stack Development Training:** A structured curriculum covering front-end and back-end technologies.
- **Monthly Coding Workshops:** Hands-on training in problem-solving and programming.
- **Mentorship & Networking:** Pairing participants with industry professionals for guidance.
- **Job Placement Assistance:** Collaboration with tech companies for internships and employment.
- **Resource Center:** A digital library with curated learning materials for continuous education.
- **Entrepreneurship & Startup Support:** Training participants on how to launch and manage their tech-based startups.

Market Analysis & Target Audience

Our target market includes young women aged 15-24, particularly those in high school, university, or early career stages. We aim to reach underserved communities by offering free and accessible training. By removing financial and geographic barriers, we ensure that girls from all backgrounds can participate. The increasing demand for digital professionals in Ethiopia, Africa, and globally presents a strong market opportunity for graduates of our program.

Business Model & Revenue Streams

To sustain operations, Cassiopeia Girls Tech will generate revenue through:

- **Corporate Sponsorships:** Partnerships with tech companies investing in diversity initiatives.
- **Grants & Donations:** Applications to international development funds supporting women's education.
- **Paid Advanced Courses:** Offering specialized training in AI, cybersecurity, and mobile development.
- **Consulting Services:** Assisting organizations in designing gender-inclusive tech education programs.
- **Freemium Model for Online Learning:** Offering free courses with paid certification options.

Operational Plan

- **Year 1:** Launch online training programs and establish mentorship networks.
- **Year 2-3:** Expand training programs, introduce regional hubs, and develop job placement initiatives.
- **Year 4-5:** Scale nationwide, expand into emerging technologies, and secure long-term partnerships.
- **Year 6 and beyond:** Expand globally by forming partnerships with organizations in Africa and other emerging markets.

Marketing & Growth Strategy

- **Social Media Engagement:** Utilizing Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, and Telegram for outreach.
- **Partnerships:** Collaborating with schools, universities, and NGOs to expand reach.
- **Community Events:** Organizing hackathons and tech meetups to foster engagement.
- **Alumni Network:** Establishing a community of graduates who can mentor new participants.
- **Local and International Conferences:** Showcasing program success stories and building credibility in the tech education space.

Financial Plan (in ETB)

Category	Year 1 Budget (ETB)	Year 2 Budget (ETB)	Year 3 Budget (ETB)
Technology Infrastructure	200,000	250,000	300,000
Instructor & Mentor Stipends	250,000	300,000	350,000
Marketing & Outreach	100,000	120,000	150,000
Operational Expenses	80,000	100,000	120,000
Training Materials & Development	150,000	180,000	200,000
Scholarships & Student Support	220,000	250,000	300,000

Total	1,000,000	1,200,000	1,420,000

Funding Sources:

- **Initial Grants & Sponsorships:** 600,000 ETB
- **Corporate & NGO Partnerships:** 250,000 ETB
- **Revenue from Paid Programs & Consulting Services:** 150,000 ETB

Risk Assessment & Sustainability Plan

Potential challenges include funding sustainability, internet accessibility, and participant retention. To mitigate these, Cassiopeia Girls Tech will establish diversified revenue streams, offer offline learning options, and maintain an engaged alumni network to support long-term growth. We will also seek government partnerships to align our programs with national digital transformation efforts.

Conclusion & Future Roadmap

Cassiopeia Girls Tech is more than just an education initiative—it is a movement toward gender inclusivity in Ethiopia's tech sector. By equipping young women with coding skills, mentorship, and career opportunities, we are fostering a new generation of female leaders in technology. With strategic partnerships, sustainable funding, and a commitment to social impact, we aim to expand nationwide and become a model for gender-focused tech education in Africa. Over the next decade, we plan to scale internationally, expanding into other African nations with similar challenges and leveraging technology to create a truly global network of empowered women in tech.